



DESIGN SYSTEM GUIDE

The ALTFTool Design Language

The single source of truth for colours, typography, spacing, components and motion across the entire ALTFTool ecosystem — web, admin, tools and every future surface.

Version
1.0

Status
Official Reference

Audience
Design · Frontend · QA · Stakeholders

Themes
Light & Dark

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01 Introduction

ALTFTool is evolving from a simple tool directory into an intelligent, AI-powered productivity workspace. As the platform grows across tools, blogs, news, dashboards and the admin panel, a single, consistent visual language keeps the product feeling like **one premium, unified product**.

This guide is the official source of truth. Every colour, size, radius and component documented here is derived from the approved ALTFTool light & dark design references and the production token layer. Designers and engineers must build against these tokens — never against ad hoc values.

Goals

Consistency

Every screen — home, dashboard, tool pages, admin — shares the same building blocks.

Velocity

Reusable tokens & components mean teams ship faster with fewer decisions.

Quality

An enterprise-grade, accessible, premium feel that scales to thousands of pages.

02 Brand Philosophy

ALTFTool's identity is **modern, intelligent and trustworthy** — a calm, confident teal–emerald brand on clean neutral canvases, with generous whitespace and crisp typography.

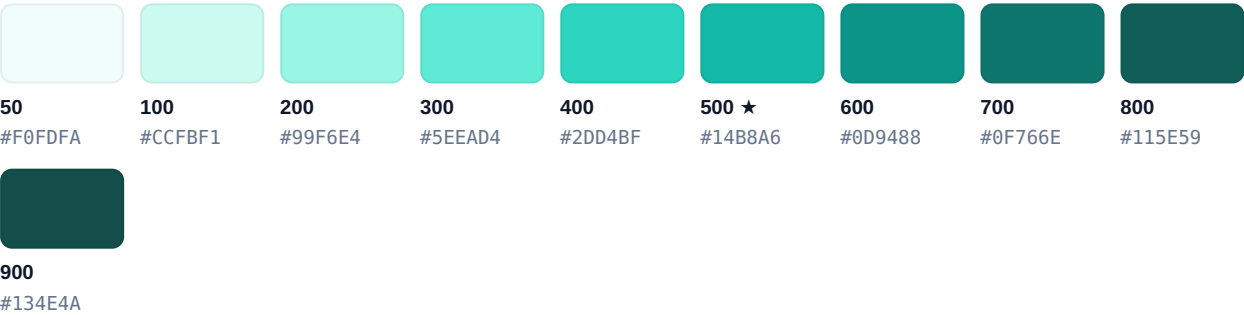
PRINCIPLE	WHAT IT MEANS IN THE UI
Premium	Soft shadows, rounded surfaces, restrained colour — never noisy.
Intelligent	The teal brand signals AI/automation; used only for primary actions & highlights.
Simplicity	One accent, neutral surfaces, clear hierarchy. Colour carries meaning, not decoration.
Accessible	WCAG AA contrast, visible focus, motion that respects user preference.
Consistent	Identical components everywhere — the platform feels like a single product.
Future-proof	Token-driven so a theme change is one source edit, not a thousand.

03 Colour System

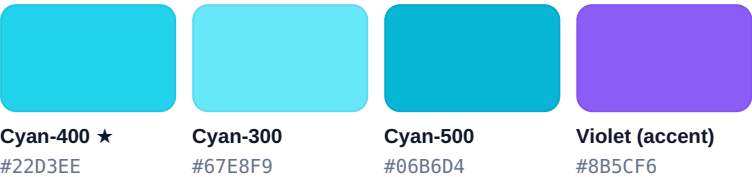
The palette is a teal–emerald brand accent over a cool neutral (slate) scale, plus a focused set of semantic status colours. Neutrals & status values map 1:1 to the production `--anslation-ds-*` tokens.

Primary — Teal (Light theme · Teal-500 ★)

Primary brand & all primary actions. **Default = 500 #14B8A6**, hover = 600, pressed = 700.



Secondary — Cyan (Cyan-400 ★)



Semantic / Status

TOKEN		HEX	RGB	USAGE
Success		#16A34A	22,163,74	Confirmations, healthy states
Warning		#F59E0B	245,158,11	Caution, non-blocking issues
Error		#EF4444	239,68,68	Destructive, validation errors
Info		#0EA5E9	14,165,233	Neutral information, tips

Neutrals — Light Theme

ROLE		HEX	TOKEN
Page background	☐	#F7F8FB	--page
Surface / Card	☐	#FFFFFF	--surface
Surface soft	☐	#EEF3F6	--surface-soft
Border	☐	#E2E8F0	--border
Border strong	☐	#CBD5E1	--border-strong

Text primary		#111827	-- foreground
Text muted		#607083	-- muted

Neutrals — Dark Theme

ROLE		HEX	TOKEN
Page		#070D18	-- page
Canvas		#0B1220	-- canvas
Surface / Card		#101827	-- surface
Surface soft		#142033	-- surface-soft
Border		#1E293B	-- border
Text		#F8FAFC	-- foreground
Text muted		#94A3B8	-- muted

Dark theme: backgrounds are navy (#070D18 / #0B1220) with dark surfaces. The primary brightens to **Teal-400 #2DD4BF** and the secondary to **Cyan-400 #22D3EE** so actions stay $\geq 4.5:1$ contrast on the navy surfaces.

04 Typography

Primary typeface: **Geist** (sans) with **Geist Mono** for code/tokens. Clean, geometric, highly legible at every size.

Discover AI Tools

Intelligent Workspace

AI Tool Categories

Body — focused, productivity-first copy that stays readable and calm.

TOKEN	SIZE	WEIGHT	LINE HEIGHT	USE
Display	40–48px	800	1.05	Hero headlines
H1	32px	700	1.15	Page titles
H2	24px	700	1.2	Section titles
H3	18px	600	1.3	Sub-sections, card titles
Body	15–16px	400	1.55	Paragraphs
Body small	13–14px	400	1.5	Secondary text
Caption / Label	11–12px	600	1.4	Labels, meta, uppercase tags
Button	13–14px	600–700	1	All button text
Mono / Code	13px	400–500	1.5	Tokens, code, values

05 Spacing System

A strict **4px base scale**. Every margin, padding and gap is a multiple of 4. This keeps rhythm consistent across the whole platform.

TOKEN	PX	SCALE	TYPICAL USE
space-1	4		Icon ↔ label, tight insets
space-2	8		Chip padding, small gaps
space-3	12		Input padding, list gaps
space-4	16		Card padding, default gap
space-5	20		Card padding (roomy)
space-6	24		Section inner spacing
space-8	32		Between blocks
space-10	40		Section gaps
space-12	48		Major section gaps
space-16	64		Hero / page section rhythm

Whitespace is a feature. Prefer more breathing room over dense layouts — it is core to the premium feel.

06 Border Radius

Soft, friendly corners. Production tokens: `--radius-sm 6` · `md 8` · `lg 12` · `xl 16`.



Small · 6px
inputs, chips



Medium · 8px
buttons, fields



Large · 12px
cards, panels



XL · 16px
modals, hero



Pill · 999
tags, toggles



Circle
avatars, dots

07 Shadow & Elevation

Three soft elevation levels. Shadows are **cool and subtle** in light mode and deeper in dark mode. Production token values below.

Elevation 1 · sm

0 1px 2px rgba(15,23,42,.06)

Cards at rest, table rows.

Elevation 2 · md

0 8px 24px rgba(15,23,42,.08)

Hover, dropdowns, popovers.

Elevation 3 · lg

0 20px 48px
rgba(15,23,42,.12)

Modals, floating panels.

LEVEL	LIGHT	DARK	USE
sm	0 1px 2px rgba(15,23,42,.06)	0 1px 2px rgba(0,0,0,.36)	Resting surfaces
md	0 8px 24px rgba(15,23,42,.08)	0 10px 28px rgba(0,0,0,.36)	Hover / dropdown
lg	0 20px 48px rgba(15,23,42,.12)	0 24px 56px rgba(0,0,0,.46)	Modal / floating

08 Gradients & Glass

Used sparingly for hero surfaces, marketing CTAs and dark-mode depth. Never on body content.

Brand Gradient

```
linear-gradient(135deg,#062E27,#0E9C7C  
70%,#14B8A6)
```

Dark Surface

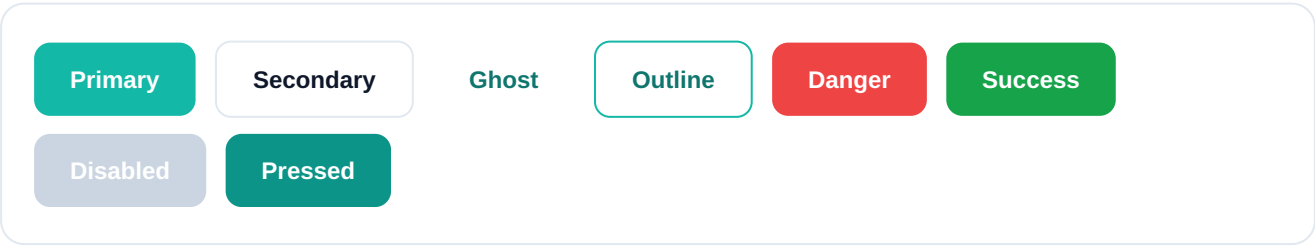
```
linear-gradient(135deg,#0B1220,#101827)
```

Glass / Blur

PROPERTY	VALUE	USE
Backdrop blur	<code>blur(16px)</code>	Sticky headers, overlays, glass cards
Glass fill (light)	<code>rgba(255,255,255,.7)</code>	Frosted panels over imagery
Glass fill (dark)	<code>rgba(16,24,39,.6)</code>	Dark frosted overlays

09 Buttons

Height 40px (md), radius 8px, weight 600–700. One primary action per view.



VARIANT	DEFAULT	HOVER	PRESSED	DISABLED
Primary	#14B8A6	#0D9488	#0F766E	#CBD5E1 / 60%
Secondary	white + border	soft #EEF3F6	#E2E8F0	50% opacity
Ghost	transparent	brand-50 fill	brand-100	50% opacity
Danger	#EF4444	#DC2626	#B91C1C	50% opacity

Focus: all buttons show a 3px ring 0 0 0 3px rgba(20,184,166,.35). Loading: spinner + label, button stays its variant colour at 80% opacity.

10 Form Components

Inputs: 40px height, radius 8px, 1px border #E2E8F0, muted placeholder. Focus = brand border + 3px ring.

Default · Focus · Error

Three input field states are shown vertically. The first is 'Default input' with a light gray border. The second is 'Focused' with a teal border and a 3px teal ring. The third is 'Invalid value' with a red border and a 3px red ring. Below the third field is a red error message: '△ This field is required.'

States & types

Text · Textarea · Select · Search · Password · OTP · Phone · Date Picker · Checkbox · Radio · Toggle.

STATE	TREATMENT
Default	border #E2E8F0
Focus	border #14B8A6 + ring
Error	border #EF4444 + message
Success	border #16A34A
Disabled	#F1F5F9 fill, 60% text

11 Cards

The core surface. Radius 12px, 1px border #E2E8F0, padding 16–20px, elevation 1 at rest → elevation 2 on hover.

Tools

Image Compressor

Compress images instantly and reduce file size
— clean title, supporting text, then a single CTA.

Open tool

Anatomy

PART	RULE
Padding	16px (sm) / 20px (roomy)
Radius	12px
Border	1px #E2E8F0
Title → body	8px gap
CTA	bottom-left, primary
Icon	top-left, 20–24px

12 Navigation

Consistent chrome across the platform: top nav, left sidebar (admin), footer, mobile drawer.

ELEMENT	SPEC
Top navbar	64px tall, white/blur sticky, logo left, primary action right, 14px links.
Sidebar (admin)	White, grouped sections, active item = brand fill + white text, icon + label, hover = soft fill.
Breadcrumb	13px muted, ">" separators, current page bold.
Footer	Dark navy (#050B18), multi-column links, muted text #94A3B8.
Mobile nav	Bottom bar or slide-in drawer; tap targets ≥ 44 px.
Sticky header	Blur(16px) + 1px bottom border on scroll.

13 Component Library

Every reusable building block shares the same tokens. Build once, reuse everywhere.

COMPONENT	KEY RULES
Badge / Tag	Pill, soft brand/status fill, 12px text, 600 weight.
Alert	Left 4px status border, soft tinted bg, icon + message.
Toast	Floating, elevation 3, auto-dismiss, status accent.
Modal	Radius 16px, elevation 3, dim backdrop rgba(2,6,23,.5), centered.
Dropdown / Menu	Radius 12px, elevation 2, 8px item padding, hover soft fill.
Tabs	Underline active (2px brand), muted inactive, icon+label.
Accordion	1px divider rows, chevron, smooth height transition.
Tooltip	Dark #0F172A bubble, white text, 8px radius, small arrow.
Pagination	Square 32px cells, active = brand fill.
Loader / Spinner	Brand stroke, 1s linear rotate.
Skeleton	Soft #F1F5F9 blocks, gentle pulse.
Avatar	Circle, initials fallback on brand fill.
Charts	Brand + sky + violet series, soft grid, rounded bars.
Table	Uppercase header on soft fill, 1px row dividers, hover soft.

14 Icon Guidelines

Icon family: **Lucide** — consistent line icons used across the product.

PROPERTY	VALUE
Style	Outline / line, rounded joins
Stroke width	1.75–2px
Sizes	16 (inline) · 20 (default) · 24 (nav/feature)
Colour	Inherits text; muted by default, brand when active
Spacing	8px from adjacent text
Alignment	Optically centred to text baseline
Hover	Colour shift to brand / foreground, never resize

15 Animation & Motion

Motion is **quick, purposeful and calm** — it guides attention, never decorates.

INTERACTION	DURATION	EASING
Hover / colour	150ms	ease-out
Button press	100ms	ease-out (scale .98)
Dropdown / popover	150ms	ease-out (fade + 4px rise)
Modal	200ms	ease-out (fade + scale .98 → 1)
Sidebar / drawer	250ms	cubic-bezier(.4,0,.2,1)
Page / route	200–300ms	ease (slide-in)
Loading spin	1s	linear (infinite)

Always honour prefers-reduced-motion: disable transforms/animation and keep only opacity fades.

16 Responsive & Grid

A fluid 12-column grid with a max content width of 1280px and generous gutters.

BREAKPOINT	MIN WIDTH	CONTAINER	COLUMNS
Mobile	0	100% – 32px	4
Tablet (sm/md)	640 / 768px	720px	8
Laptop (lg)	1024px	960px	12
Desktop (xl)	1280px	1200px	12
Ultra-wide (2xl)	1536px	1280px (capped)	12

Spacing scales down one step on mobile (e.g. 24px → 16px). Cards stack to a single column; sidebars collapse to a drawer.

17 Accessibility

Target **WCAG 2.1 AA** across the platform.

AREA	REQUIREMENT
Contrast	Text $\geq 4.5:1$, large text/UI $\geq 3:1$. Brand-on-white & teal-on-dark verified.
Focus	Visible 3px focus ring on every interactive element; never remove outlines without a replacement.
Keyboard	All actions reachable & operable by keyboard; logical tab order.
ARIA / Semantics	Semantic HTML first; ARIA only to fill gaps. Label every control & icon-button.
Motion	Respect prefers - reduced - motion.
Targets	Touch targets $\geq 44 \times 44$ px.

18 Performance Guidelines

PRACTICE	RULE
Images	Modern formats (WebP/AVIF), correct sizing, <code>next/image</code> where possible.
Lazy loading	Defer below-the-fold media & heavy modules.
SVG / icons	Inline SVG, tree-shaken icon imports (named, not whole library).
Reuse	Shared components & tokens — no duplicated one-off styles.
Bundles	Code-split routes; keep client JS lean; SSR/ISR where it helps SEO & speed.
Fonts	Self-hosted, <code>font-display: swap</code> , subset.

19 Code & Token Architecture

Everything is token-driven. **No hardcoded colours, radius, shadows or spacing** — ever.

Forbidden: `color:#14B8A6, border-radius:12px, box-shadow:0 8px 24px...` inline.

Required: `bg-primary, rounded-lg, shadow-md, var(--surface)`.

Token layers

LAYER	EXAMPLE	NOTES
Primitive	<code>--anslation-ds-primary: #14B8A6</code>	Raw brand value (one place)
Semantic	<code>--primary: var(--anslation-ds-primary)</code>	Role-based alias used in UI
Theme map	<code>@theme { --color-primary: var(--primary) }</code>	Exposes Tailwind utilities
Utility	<code>bg-primary / text-primary</code>	What components actually use

A theme change = edit the primitive layer once. Light/Dark switch via `[data-theme="dark"]` overrides on the same semantic names.

20 Global Implementation Rules

Every surface of ALTFTool must use this exact design language. The platform must feel like **one unified premium product**.

MUST BE CONSISTENT

Home	Dashboard
Extensions	Tool Pages
Search	Blog
Pricing	Authentication
Profile	Settings
Admin Panel	Documentation
Error pages	Loading pages
...and every future feature.	

No page should look different. New work ships only with design-token styling, AA accessibility, and the components defined in this guide. This document is the single source of truth — when in doubt, match it exactly.

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